



THE NEXT REVOLUTION

(From left) **Sakshi Batra**

Dinesh Kumar Khara, Former Chairman, SBI

Rajneesh Karnatak, MD & CEO, Bank of India

Nidhu Saxena, MD & CEO, Bank of Maharashtra

Zarin Daruwala, Group CEO, PL Capital

» “Banking is a function of trust. Earning that trust requires brick-and-mortar presence,” said Khara. “Creating a distribution network today is a huge challenge,” he added

» As the economy is progressing, a lot of financial literacy is happening, believes Karnatak. “Customers now invest in equity markets, mutual funds, pension funds and gold, there is definitely some shift,” he said

» Saxena said in the last one to two years, to chase CASA deposits, private banks have been opening branches aggressively in rural and semi-urban centres where public-sector banks enjoyed a monopoly earlier

» Daruwala said AI can help manage some of the risks in the banking sector. She added she is hopeful that Indian banks will also step up their investments in AI



NEW MODEL FOR MICROFINANCE

(From left) **Alok Misra**, CEO & Director, Microfinance Institutions Network

Ravi Narayanan, MD & CEO, SMFG India Credit

» Responding to questions on whether pure-play MFIs will survive till 2047 or evolve into diversified financial hubs, Misra said predicting that far ahead is speculative, adding that scaling nano and micro enterprises is critical for inclusive growth

» Narayanan said microfinance does not need a structural overhaul but a measured evolution. He emphasised that the sector’s foundational goal was to bring the “credit invisible” into the formal system—a target India has largely achieved